THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Source: 'Forts are the foundation of the kingdom.' A king who says this probably depends on 1

(a) defence of strategic places **(b)** no army
(c) open-plain wars **(d)** sea trade only

2. The Marathas' confrontation with the British is explained by 1

(a) trade only **(b)** no contact
(c) British seeing them as the main rival **(d)** British friendship

3. The significance of the cultural revival under Shivaji was 1

(a) foreign adoption **(b)** local language and identity
(c) ban **(d)** end of language

4. If an official's post is hereditary, the likely risk to the ruler is 1

(a) lower taxes **(b)** faster travel
(c) growth of independent power **(d)** more trade

5. A queen leads an army after her husband's death; this was true of 1

(a) Tarabai **(b)** Jijabai **(c)** Jodha **(d)** Mastani

6. If a coastal fort resists European and Mughal ships, it shows 1

(a) neglect **(b)** trade
(c) peace **(d)** strong sea defence

7. A force raids a camp at night and vanishes before dawn. This is typical of 1

(a) siege **(b)** formal battle
(c) naval war **(d)** guerrilla warfare

8. Which is a reasonable inference from Shivaji's escape from Agra? 1

(a) He lost support **(b)** He could think and plan under pressure
(c) He had no plan **(d)** He loved Aurangzeb

9. **Assertion (A):** Shivaji built a navy for the Marathas. 1
Reason (R): A navy was needed to secure the west coast.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Chauth was a tax equal to one-fourth of the revenue. 1
Reason (R): Sardeshmukhi was an extra levy of 10 per cent.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did Shivaji not allow cutting of mango and jackfruit trees? 2

12. What does the Treaty of Purandar tell us about Shivaji's leadership? 2

13. What does Tarabai's role show about the Marathas? 2

14. A fort is built on a hill with sea on one side. What advantages does it give? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Source: 'Forts are the core of the state; ships are the sea forts' (Adnyapatra idea). Explain what the writer says about Maratha defence. 3

16. Analyse why the Marathas could not hold north India after Panipat. 3

17. Case: Traders are protected at sea by naval patrols. Explain the benefits to the economy. 3

OR

Case: A ruler pays soldiers regularly and moves officials every few years. Identify the ruler and the aim. 3

18. Interpret: 'The Maratha navy challenged the cartaz system.' What does it show? 3

OR

Why might historians disagree about chauth? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** At Pratapgad, Shivaji met the Bijapur general Afzal Khan, who had come to subdue him. Shivaji killed him using a concealed steel weapon. Later his soldiers attacked Shaista Khan's camp at Pune at night, and Shivaji raided the rich Mughal port of Surat. 5
(i) Name the weapon used against Afzal Khan.
(ii) At the foot of which fort did the meeting take place?
(iii) Which Mughal port was raided?
(iv) Why did guerrilla tactics suit the Marathas against the Mughals?

20. Analyse the factors that enabled a small kingdom to challenge the Mughal Empire. 5

OR

How do sources such as the Adnyapatra and Modi records help us understand Maratha rule? 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks